QUEENS PEACE PALACE

AFTER ABUSE: THE RECLAMATION

A Trauma-Informed Guided Reflection for Rebuilding
Safety, Voice, Boundaries & Self-Trust

NAME. RECLAIM. RETURN.

TO THY OWN SELF BE TRUE

The Inner Work Collection

Before You Begin

Abuse can include physical, sexual, emotional or psychological harm, as well as neglect. Its effects can reach far beyond the original experience - into safety, boundaries, self-worth, anger, trust, relationships, body awareness and the way you speak to yourself.

The original Queens Peace Palace worksheet included affirmations, safe-space reflection, anger processing, self-talk work, forgiveness prompts and a third-person childhood exercise designed to create self-compassion. This edition keeps those intentions, but approaches them with more choice and care.

> **You do not need to describe the abuse in detail to use this workbook.**
> You are allowed to skip any question, stop at any point, or work only with the present-day effects. Healing does not require forcing yourself to relive what happened.

A note on safety & support

This workbook is for personal reflection and education; it is not therapy, diagnosis, crisis care, or a substitute for trauma treatment. If abuse is ongoing, your immediate safety matters more than completing these pages. If reflection becomes overwhelming, pause and consider support from a licensed trauma-informed mental-health professional or another qualified service.

YOUR INTENTION

What would you like to reclaim for yourself through this reflection?

What did the experience teach your system to expect?

You can begin with the effects rather than the event itself. Notice what your life learned to do in order to survive, anticipate danger, reduce conflict, or stay connected.

Today, I notice the experience affecting my...

- ■ Ability to trust
- ■ Boundaries
- ■ Self-worth
- ■ Relationships
- ■ Sense of safety
- ■ Anger
- ■ Ability to say no
- ■ Need for control
- ■ Body comfort or awareness
- ■ Conflict responses
- ■ Ability to receive care
- ■ Self-talk
- ■ Other: _____

The pattern that affects my life the most right now is...

What does that pattern help you avoid, prevent, or prepare for?

What helped you survive may not be what you need forever.

Your original worksheet asked you to examine a trauma response and its cost versus benefit. Keep that wisdom: a response can have protected you and still be limiting you now.

A response I developed to protect myself is...

HOW IT HELPED ME

WHAT IT COSTS ME NOW

What would a more flexible, present-day response look like?

Palace Reflection
You do not have to shame a survival response in order to update it.

What helps your body and mind recognize: I am here now?

The original workbook asked you to write about your safe space. This edition expands that idea beyond a single room. Safety can be environmental, relational, emotional, practical and internal.

I feel safest when...

People feel safer to me when they...

My environment feels safer when...

Three things that help me return to the present when I feel activated are...

What is one concrete change that would make your current life feel safer?

Your boundaries do not require permission.

One of the strongest affirmations in the original worksheet was the right to say no and remain worthy of love and care. After abuse, boundary-setting can carry fear, guilt, freezing, overexplaining or the expectation of punishment.

I find it hardest to say no when...

What do you fear may happen when you set a boundary?

A boundary I wish I had been allowed to have is...

A boundary I am allowed to have NOW is...

Practice language
“No.” “That doesn't work for me.” “I need space.” “I am not comfortable with that.” “I am ending this conversation.”

Which messages never belonged to you?

Your original worksheet asked you to list negative messages you repeat and counter them with self-accepting statements. This page turns that into a reclamation of voice.

A cruel, critical or condemning message I still carry is...

Where did I learn or absorb that message?

What is more truthful, compassionate and mine?

Another message I am ready to return to its source:

What I choose to believe instead:

Anger can exist without becoming destruction.

The original workbook made room for anger and suggested writing an unsent letter. Anger after abuse can hold grief, injustice, violated boundaries, lost time, fear and the truth that something should not have happened.

What are you angry about TODAY - without forcing yourself into details you do not want to revisit?

What does this anger know was wrong, unfair or unacceptable?

What does your anger want to protect now?

Optional unsent letter:
If it feels supportive, write privately to the person, situation, institution, or younger version of yourself. You never have to send it, share it, forgive anyone, or finish it.

Compassion without forced reliving.

Your original worksheet suggested writing about childhood in the third person to create distance and self-compassion. If that feels supportive, you can use the exercise below. If not, skip it.

Write about younger you as if you were describing a child you deeply wanted to protect. You may focus on who they were, what they deserved, what they loved, or what they needed - not necessarily what happened to them.

When you read what you wrote, what do you feel toward that younger version of you?

What were they never responsible for carrying?

What belongs to you now?

Abuse involves violations of choice, power, safety or care. Reclamation can include practicing choice in ordinary places again - what you want, who has access to you, what you disclose, what you wear, how you rest, what relationships you keep, and what healing means to you.

I have the right to choose...

I no longer owe anyone access to...

I want more agency in...

One small choice I can make this week purely because it belongs to me is...

Your healing is yours.
There is no required timeline, emotional performance, relationship outcome, confrontation, or forgiveness milestone you must complete to prove you are healing.

Release can mean many things.

The original worksheet included forgiveness lists and letters. In this edition, forgiveness remains available as an optional personal process - not a requirement. You may forgive, not forgive, feel undecided, grieve, create distance, pursue accountability, or simply stop organizing your life around the harm.

What does forgiveness mean to ME - separate from what I have been told it should mean?

What would I like to release for MY sake, even if I never reconcile?

What do I need to keep - a boundary, lesson, truth, distance, record, or discernment - even if I release some of the emotional weight?

Release is not denial.
Compassion does not require renewed access. Forgiveness, if you choose it, does not rewrite what happened.

Speak to yourself from dignity.

The original affirmations centered worth, individuality, permission, respect and the right to say no. These statements keep that foundation without requiring you to feel positive every moment.

“What happened to me does not determine my human worth.”

“My no is complete even when someone dislikes it.”

“I am allowed to choose what healing looks like for me.”

“I can learn safety without blaming myself for how I survived.”

“I do not owe access to anyone who violates my boundaries.”

“My body, voice, time and choices belong to me.”

Write three statements that speak directly to what YOU are reclaiming.

1.

2.

3.

What do you want your life to belong to now?

Healing is not only about understanding what hurt you. It is also about making room for what you want to build beyond it.

Something I want to experience more of is...

Something I want to trust myself with again is...

A relationship standard I am reclaiming is...

A part of myself I want to know outside of survival is...

One promise I want to make to myself moving forward is...

THE PALACE CHECK-IN

Do not measure healing only by whether the past still affects you. Ask: “Do I have more choice? More voice? More discernment? More compassion for myself? More ability to protect my peace without disappearing from my own life?”

RETURN TO YOURSELF

What happened may be part of your story.

It does not get authorship over the rest of it.

You are allowed to reclaim yourself slowly. You are allowed to have complicated feelings. You are allowed to protect what is yours now: your voice, your boundaries, your body, your time, your relationships, your choices and the life you are still creating.

Remember:
You do not have to become untouched by the past to become increasingly free in the present.

Need support going deeper?

If this reflection uncovered something you would like support navigating, Queens Peace Palace offers private Spiritual Life Coaching for clarity, self-trust, relationships, transitions and personal growth. For trauma treatment, diagnosis, crisis support, or ongoing abuse, work with an appropriately qualified professional or service.

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